

# Scottish Baronial

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**A**longside the classical and Gothic revivals of the 19th century, Scotland saw its own independent revival. Adopting elements of fortified local tower houses of the 16th century, and blended with medieval, Gothic and Renaissance components, Scottish Baronial style appealed to national pride. It was also inspired by the historical novels of Sir Walter Scott (1771–1832) and his house at Abbotsford, built in 1824 in the Scottish borders, with stepped gables and projecting turrets. When Queen Victoria acquired Balmoral as a holiday home and had it rebuilt in 1852–6, the crenellations, lancet windows and turrets of Balmoral became common features of the Scottish Baronial style, along with rough-hewn stone, gables and steep roofs. First emerging in rural areas, the style spread to cities, where townhouses adopted elements of the revival, such as crow-stepped gables, small windows and tiny bartizans (turrets) added to façades. The most prominent Scottish Baronial architects were William Burn (1789–1870), his pupil David Bryce (1803–76) and also Bryce's pupil, Charles G.H. Kinnear (1830–94).



**Torosay Castle, Isle of Mull, David Bryce, 1858**